

I venture to guess that that teenaged girl wasn't worried about whether her LV bag would retain its value. I doubt it can. Why? *Because everybody will have owned that bag.* The brand will saturate the market. In ten years' time, that bag won't be worth anything.

When you're young, you think time is on your side. Time *is* on your side, but not when you're being a consumer, something teenagers are very, very good at. As a consumer, time is your enemy, and the people who make your gadgets and games know this. And they use it to their advantage. As an investor, however, when you're young, *time is your best friend.* In fact, it's the only thing you have going for you when you're young, precisely because you don't have a lot of money. Best news is, you don't need a lot of money to make great returns! You just need a future. Are you following?

Money Mistake: Saving Money Isn't as Cool as Spending It

THE FIX: YOUR "SECRET 10" IS YOUR SECRET WEAPON

Saving money is hard when you're young because young people like tangibles, labels, proof that they own something of value, something cool that everyone else wants. Saving is also hard because you don't have anything real to show for all of your discipline and sacrifice. But the hardest thing of all is saving 10 percent of your income, because to pull that off you have to pass on stuff that will gratify you immediately. So you probably don't have the newest iPad, you don't have photos from spring break, and you don't have the top-of-the-line snowboard. And when you're a teenager, that stuff matters. But so do things like power, security, and freedom. When you have money, a healthy stash that can come to your rescue at a moment's notice, you have something other kids don't. I like to call this secret stash of money the Secret 10. It's the 10 percent of your income that you're spiriting away and saving for later. It grows alongside you. Your Secret 10 accompanies you all through life, following you from your childhood bedroom to your dorm room, to the master suite, to your deathbed. It's your money, your superpower. The sooner you start